TIMELINE OF THE WORLD

1863 Abraham Lincoln signs the Emancipation Proclamation to abolish slavery in the United States

1869 The first transcontinental railroad is completed in America, connecting the nation from east to west

1879 Thomas Edison invents the electric light bulb

1889 The Eiffel Tower is built as the entrance for the World's Fair in Paris

1895 Italian inventor Guglielmo Marconi sends the first communication over radio signals

1909 Robert Peary and Matthew Henson discover the North Pole

1914 World War I begins

1920 The United States passes the Nineteenth Amendment, giving women the right to vote

1922 Archaeologist Howard Carter discovers the tomb of Egyptian pharaoh Tutankhamen

1939 World War II begins

1948 The official government policy of apartheid (a separation of whites and nonwhites) begins in South Africa

1963 Dr. Martin Luther King Jr. gives his famous "I Have a Dream" speech in Washington, DC, to speak out for equal rights of black Americans

1979 Mother Teresa is awarded the Nobel Peace Prize for her work with the poor in India